# JOHNSON C. SMITH UNIVERSITY

## College of Business and Professional Studies | Sport Management Program

## SPM 435-A: Sport Sociology and Ethics (3 Credit Hours)

*Fall Semester | Enhanced with Transatlantic COIL Virtual Exchange (U.S. / South Africa)*

| Course & Instructor Information | Transatlantic COIL Partner Information |
|---|---|
| **Instructor:** Dr. Micah J. Dobson<br>**Title:** Assistant Professor of Sport Management<br>**Office:** JCSU Campus / Online Office<br>**Email:** contact@drmicahdobson.com \| mdobson@jcsu.edu<br>**Office Hours:** Mon/Wed 1:00 PM – 3:00 PM EST (or by appt) | **Collaborating Faculty:** Dr. Makhaya Malema<br>**Host Department:** Dept. of Sport, Recreation & Exercise Science (SRES)<br>**Host Institution:** University of the Western Cape (UWC), South Africa<br>**Partner Course:** SRE 743: Advanced Sport Management & Sociology<br>**Modality:** Collaborative Online International Learning (COIL) |

## 1. Course Description & Philosophy

*SPM 435: Sport Sociology and Ethics* provides a critical, interdisciplinary investigation into the structural, cultural, and political dynamics of sport within contemporary global society. The course examines how sport operates as both a reflection of societal inequalities and an active arena for contesting race, gender, socioeconomic class, power, and ethics.

During the semester, this course integrates a dedicated 6-week **Collaborative Online International Learning (COIL)** virtual exchange module co-delivered with **Dr. Makhaya Malema** at the **University of the Western Cape (UWC)**. Students from Johnson C. Smith University (HBCU) and UWC (HDI) will engage in collaborative case studies, virtual dialogue sessions, and comparative policy evaluations, examining parallel civil rights and post-apartheid athletic transformation frameworks.

## 2. Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs)

Upon successful completion of SPM 435, students will be able to:

1. **Sociological Analysis:** Critically evaluate the intersections of race, gender, class, and nationality within intercollegiate, professional, and global sports systems.
2. **Ethical Decision-Making:** Apply ethical frameworks to analyze governance controversies, doping, athlete activism, and commercialization in modern athletic organizations.
3. **Transatlantic Comparative Competency:** Compare sport governance policies and transformation mandates between U.S. collegiate sport (NCAA/HBCUs) and South African athletics (HDIs/National Sport Plan).
4. **Cross-Cultural Collaboration:** Work effectively in multinational virtual student teams to co-produce actionable policy recommendations for real-world sport organizations.
5. **Community Application:** Understand grassroots sport as a tool for youth development, psychosocial wellness, and social equity in urban communities (e.g., Charlotte, NC & Cape Flats, South Africa).

## 3. Required Course Materials

- **Required Textbook:** Coakley, J. (2021). *Sports in Society: Issues and Controversies* (13th ed.). McGraw-Hill Higher Education.
- **Supplemental Readings:** Peer-reviewed journal articles, policy white papers, and documentary excerpts provided on Canvas.
- **Technology Requirements:** Reliable internet access, Canvas LMS, Zoom for live transatlantic sessions, and Microsoft Word.

## 4. Instructional Format & Assessment Structure

**Assessment Overview:**

- **Chapter Review Questions (16 × 20 pts = 320 pts):** Weekly analytical question sets submitted via Canvas to ensure mastery of theoretical concepts.
- **Discussion Boards (16 × 20 pts = 320 pts):** Substantive weekly forum posts (16 pts) and minimum two peer responses (4 pts).
- **Case Studies (2 × 100 pts = 200 pts):** In-depth ethical and sociological case analyses applying course theories to live athletic dilemmas.
- **Midterm Oral Presentation (100 pts):** Structured oral evaluation analyzing sporting behavior and ethical leadership.
- **Transatlantic COIL Capstone (100 pts):** Joint collaborative case study co-developed in mixed JCSU-UWC student teams.
- **Final Research Project / Proposal (100 pts):** Culminating scholarly paper or community sport proposal.
- **Attendance & Participation (100 pts):** Active engagement in class and virtual exchange sessions.

| Grade Component | Points |
|---|---|
| Review Questions (16) | 320 pts (26%) |
| Discussion Boards (16) | 320 pts (26%) |
| Case Studies (2) | 200 pts (16%) |
| Midterm Presentation | 100 pts (8%) |
| COIL Capstone Project | 100 pts (8%) |
| Final Research Paper | 100 pts (8%) |
| Attendance/Engagement | 100 pts (8%) |
| **Total** | **1,240 pts (100%)** |

## 5. Transatlantic COIL Virtual Exchange Crosswalk (Weeks 7–12)

**Collaborative Modules with University of the Western Cape (UWC, South Africa):**

- **Module 1 (Weeks 7–8): Historical Foundations of Race, Sport, and Resistance:** Comparative analysis of the U.S. Civil Rights movement and HBCU athletic evolution alongside South Africa's anti-apartheid sport boycott (SANROC/SACOS) and HDI histories.
- **Module 2 (Weeks 9–10): Governance, Policy, and Structural Transformation:** Critical evaluation of NCAA/HBCU institutional resource policies contrasted with South Africa's *National Sport and Recreation Plan* and university transformation mandates.
- **Module 3 (Week 11): Community Sport & Psychosocial Wellness:** Guest lectures featuring leaders from Cape Town's *Play Sport4Life (PS4L)* and Charlotte youth sports organizations examining athletic access in underserved urban areas.
- **Module 4 (Week 12): COIL Transatlantic Policy Capstone:** Mixed JCSU and UWC student teams co-analyze an athletic policy challenge and present joint strategic recommendations.

## 6. Comprehensive Semester Course Schedule

| Week / Dates | Topic & Chapter Readings | Deliverables & Deadlines |
|---|---|---|
| **Week 1** (Aug 19–24) | Course Introduction & Ch. 1: Sport and How We Study It | Syllabus Review; Ch. 1 Review Questions; Discussion 1 |
| **Week 2** (Aug 24–31) | Ch. 2: Impact of Sport Participants and Spectators | Ch. 2 Review Questions; Discussion 2 (Add/Drop: Aug 26) |
| **Week 3** (Sept 1–8) | Ch. 3: Sport Business, Management, and Media (Labor Day) | Ch. 3 Review Questions; Discussion 3 |
| **Week 4** (Sept 9–14) | Ch. 4: Youth Sports and Development Through Sport | Ch. 4 Review Questions; Discussion 4; **Case Study 1** |
| **Week 5** (Sept 15–21) | Ch. 5: Coaching and Leadership in Sports | Ch. 5 Review Questions; Discussion 5 |
| **Week 6** (Sept 22–28) | Ch. 6: Interscholastic and Intercollegiate Sport (NCAA/HBCU) | Ch. 6 Review Questions; Discussion 6 |
| **Week 7** (Sept 29–Oct 5) | **COIL Module 1 Launch:** Ch. 7: International Sports & Olympics | Ch. 7 Review Questions; Discussion 7; COIL Icebreaker |
| **Week 8** (Oct 6–12) | **Midterm Week:** Ch. 8 (Ethics), Ch. 9 (Race), Ch. 10 (Gender) | **Oral Midterm Presentations**; Ch. 8–10 Review; DB 8–10 |
| **Week 9** (Oct 13–20) | **Fall Break** (Campus Closed; Class resumes Oct 21) | COIL Team Check-in & Case Framing |
| **Week 10** (Oct 21–26) | **COIL Module 2:** Ch. 11: Social Class and Sport Governance | Ch. 11 Review; Discussion 11; **Case Study 2** |
| **Week 11** (Oct 27–Nov 2) | **COIL Module 3:** Ch. 12: Inclusive Sport & Community Access | Ch. 12 Review; Discussion 12; Play Sport4Life Case |
| **Week 12** (Nov 3–9) | **COIL Module 4:** Ch. 13: Religion, Values, and Global Sport | **Transatlantic COIL Capstone Presentation Due** |
| **Weeks 13–15** (Nov 10–23) | Ch. 14: Government, Politics, and Sport Policy | Ch. 14 Review; Discussion 14; Final Project Draft |
| **Thanksgiving Break** | November 24–30 (University Holiday) | Independent Project Revisions |
| **Week 16** (Dec 1–7) | Ch. 15 (Deviance/Violence) & Ch. 16 (Future Trends) | **Final Research Project / Proposal Due** (Dec 7) |

## 7. Institutional Policies & Academic Integrity

- **Academic Honesty:** Johnson C. Smith University maintains strict adherence to academic integrity. Plagiarism, unauthorized collaboration, or unapproved AI text generation are strictly prohibited and result in formal judicial review.
- **Attendance & Engagement:** In accordance with JCSU policy, unexcused absences exceeding 20% of scheduled class sessions may result in a one-letter grade reduction. Active engagement in virtual exchange sessions is required.
- **Accommodations:** Students with documented disabilities should contact the JCSU Center for Academic Excellence and Accessibility Services for confidential support and academic adjustments.
- **James B. Duke Memorial Library:** Students are encouraged to leverage JCSU library databases, OneSearch, and research consultations for all literature reviews and empirical assignments.